

A WHOPPING RS 37 CR HAS BEEN GIVEN TO 18 MUTHS AND TEMPLES

BK RAMESH

BANGALORE | Holy Day

Call it an act of redemption. On Mahashivratri, the BJP Government ensured that 50,000 litres of *Gangajal* was distributed to devotees. About 1,500 temples in the state were more than happy to distribute the *Gangajal*. And why not? The state budget might have caused disillusionment among the citizens, but that didn't stop the Government from allocating Rs 37 crore to 18 *muths* and temples across the state. A sum of Rs 10 crore has been set aside for centres that promote communal harmony. Khwaja Aminuddin Dargah of Bijapur and the Shirahatti Fakir Swamy Muth in Gadag have found a place in the list. *by Nirmala Ravindran*

DEVOTEES CLAIM THEIR SHARE OF GANGAJAL



750

crore rupees will be invested by India Rizing Fund in small defence firms.

MUMBAI | Miffed Minister

The grapes couldn't have been more sour. A day after newly inducted Minister of State Naseem Khan was given charge of the Home Department (Urban), Minister of State for Home Nitin Raut registered his protest by returning his official car to the Nagpur district collector's office. Raut is upset at being left only with the rural charge, while Khan will have the city commissionerates under him. The sulking bandwagon also includes Congressman Govindrao Adik whose name was dropped from the list of ministers a few hours before the swearing-in. *by Aditi Pai*

MAK TODAY



mentary waters. The district authorities in Mangalore have already issued externment notices to the Sene leadership. *by Stephen David*

DELHI | War on Recession



TEJAS LIGHT COMBAT AIRCRAFT

India's defence sector is recession-proof but there are pitfalls associated with its sole customer—the Government—which is one reason why investors have traditionally shied away from nearly 5,000 small and medium enterprises (SMEs). The recently launched India Rizing Fund will invest Rs 750 crore into the SMEs that supply sub-components to defence projects like the Tejas Light Combat aircraft. The fund assumes significance because an offset clause introduced by the Government makes it mandatory for foreign arms firms to reinvest 30 per cent of the value of a contract in Indian industry. "The fund will help SMEs set up infrastructure to meet offset agreements," says Rajesh Narayan, the fund's managing trustee.

by Sandeep Unnithan

Role Reversal

West Bengal's district administrations will no longer be the sole deciding authority on which booths can be marked "sensitive" for the next Lok Sabha elections. The Election Commission will jointly take a decision, along with the district administration, on the nature of the booths. Debashish Sen, chief electoral officer West Bengal, said. *by Elora Sen*